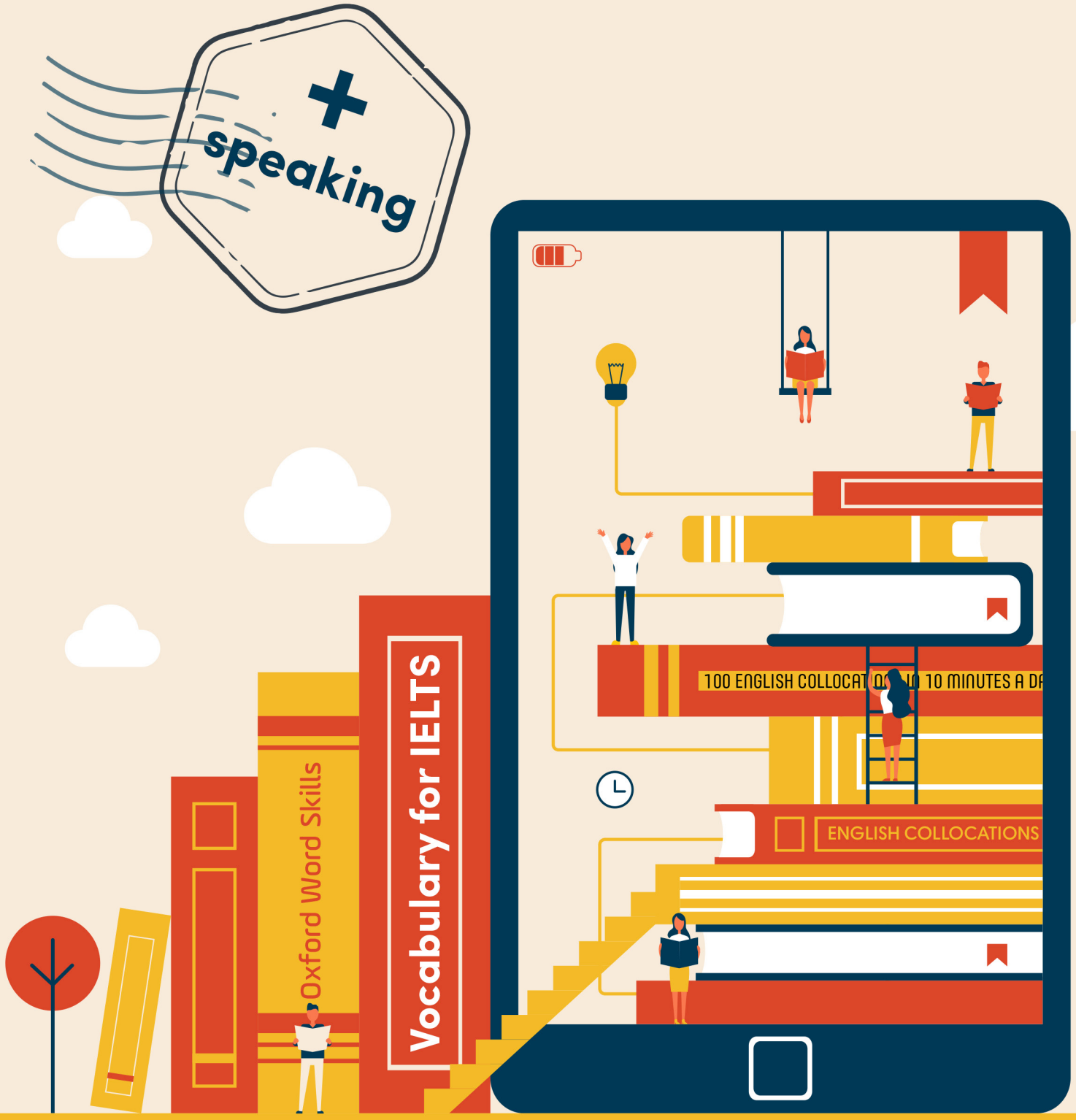
IELTS Up Words!

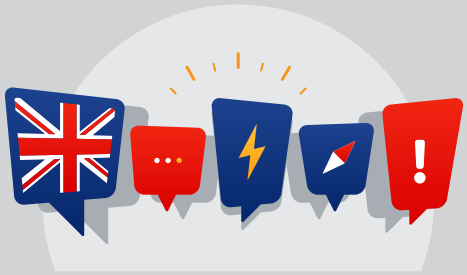
دوره لغات آیلتس

Yasaman Esmaeili

Yasi.esl



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IELTS Up Words!

Lesson 58: Animal rights

Hello, welcome to lesson fifty-eight of IELTS Up Words! In this lesson, we will talk about those creatures that you sometimes see walking next to people, or in jungles, mountains, or even oceans. Yes, I am talking about animals. Some animals are kept as pets, some cannot be tamed and live in the wild, some are aquatic invertebrates, like jellyfish, some are flightless birds, like penguins, some venomous, like tarantulas, and some have become domesticated, like sheep.

And just like human rights, we have something called animal rights. The fundamental principle of the modern animal rights movement is that many non-human animals deserve protection. What do you think about this? Do you think it is hypocritical if we say we care about animals and at the same time consume their meat?

Now, let's go through two questions about this topic. The first one is a part one question and the second one a part three sample question.

Ready?

Are people in your country fond of animals?

Not really. Most people here are still cruel to animals, especially to stray dogs and feral cats. Just the other day, I saw a couple of boys torturing a rat, which was heartbreaking.

Compared with the past, have there been any changes concerning animals in your country?

Although there are still many people who commit acts of cruelty to animals in Iran, I think more and more people are waking up to the fact that this way of treating animals is appalling and should be addressed. For example, I remember that a couple of months ago, an upsetting image of a dog being abused was distributed on Instagram, which received a lot of backlash against animal abuse. This change is promising, but there is still a lot more that should be done.

In lesson nine of the book “Vocabulary for IELTS Advanced,” there is a listening part that I am going to play for you now. It is about the speaker’s opinion on animal testing. Listen and then tell me whether you agree with her or not.

I think it’s absolutely horrifying the way we treat animals sometimes, especially when it’s done for research purposes. I find the images of caged animals being forced to smoke quite distressing. And it’s even more outrageous when all this research is done for cosmetics. It’s not a subject that I can be objective about, I’m afraid. And I think it’s absolutely essential we find a different way of doing this type of research.

Speaking Tip



Speaking Tip

V or W?

One of the biggest pronunciation mistakes of Iranian language learners and test-takers is how they pronounce V or W.

This is not an “accent” problem, but rather a “pronunciation” problem that needs to be addressed.

When pronouncing W, form an O with your mouth and don’t let your teeth touch your lower lip.

When pronouncing V, your upper teeth should touch your lower lip.

topic-related words and structures	meaning	translation	other structures
aquatic invertebrate	a spineless animal that lives in the water	حیوان بی‌مهرهٔ آبزی	vertebrate
jellyfish	a sea creature with a soft, oval, almost transparent body	عروس دریایی	sea jelly
flightless birds	birds that are naturally unable to fly	پرندهٔ بی‌پرواز	flying birds
venomous	poisonous	سمّی	comparing with toxic and poisonous venomous arachnid
domesticated animals	(of animals or plants) brought under human control in order to provide food, power, or company	حیوانات اهلی شده	compare with domestic
animal rights	the rights of animals to be treated well, for example by not being used for testing drugs or by not being hunted	حقوق حیوانات	animal rights activist
to be cruel to animals	to be extremely unkind and unpleasant and to cause pain to animals intentionally	بی‌رحمی با حیوانات	animal cruelty; animal abuse
stray dogs	dogs that no longer have a home or cannot find their home	سگ‌های سرگردان	street dogs

topic-related words and structures	meaning	translation	other structures
feral cats	a feral cat is an un-owned domestic cat that lives outdoors and avoids human contact	گربه‌های وحشی	compared with stray cats Stray cats are socialized to humans— in most cases, they were once pets who have either become lost or were, unfortunately, abandoned—while feral cats have had very limited (or no) interactions with humans and have reverted to a wild state.
torturing rats	causing intense suffering to rats; inflicting pain on rats	شکنجهٔ موش‌ها	Torturous mistreat (verb)
to commit acts of cruelty to animals	to cause suffering to animals	انجام اعمال بی‌رحمانه‌ای نسبت به حیوانات	to inflict cruelty
the appalling treatment of animals	the horrific acts toward animals	رفتاری نسبت به حیوانات که موجب انزجار و هراس آن‌ها می‌شود	shocking; horrifying
backlash against animal abuse	a strong, negative reaction toward animal cruelty	واکنش شدید نسبت به حیوان‌آزاری	
animal testing	doing scientific tests on animals when developing new products or drugs	آزمایش حیوانات	animal experimentation

other words/ structures	meaning	translation	other structures
hypocritical	having particular moral beliefs but behaving in a way that shows these are not sincere	متظاهر؛ریاکار	hypocrite
the fundamental principle	the most basic or most important concept; philosophy	اصل بنیادی	basic principle
to wake up to something	to become aware of something	نسبت به چیزی آگاه‌شدن	
an upsetting image	an unpleasant image	تصویرناراحت‌کننده	A disturbing image
absolutely horrifying	extremely frightening	کاملاًوحشتناک	terrifying
distressing	upsetting; worrying	دردناک؛پریشان‌کننده	dreadful
outrageous	shocking and morally unacceptable	تکان‌دهنده	
cosmetics	substances that you put on your face or body that are intended to improve your appearance	لوازم آرایشی	beauty products; make-up



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